at the vineyard."

"Is that where you work?"

"Yes, for the moment. It's the *vendange*, harvest time, so I'm staying there to help out." He smiled. "Next week, I can get off early on Monday. Shall we meet at the cathedral at three o'clock?"

"I thought you didn't like coming into town."

"I don't." He grinned. "But for you, I'll make an exception."

"See you then," Rose said, tucking the sketchbook under her arm. As she left the bench to head back to Orléans, the light on the river had changed, becoming softer and warmer. Shadows from the poplars along the bank stretched across the water. She felt different, too. She held the sketchbook close, recalling André's hand gliding over the paper, drawing her face. With every step, her heart climbed and her pulse quickened.

* * *

The rest of the week seemed to drag on forever, but finally, Monday arrived. Rose, filled with anticipation, brought her sketchbook—she was excited to show André how she'd used the perspective technique he'd taught her while drawing the statue of Jeanne d'Arc in Place du Martroi. She arrived at the cathedral fifteen minutes early, giving herself plenty of time. Knowing that André worked on a vineyard on the outskirts of Orléans, she didn't expect him to be waiting for her like last time.

As she stood before the cathedral's main doors, the bright sun warmed her shoulders and memories of her mother came to her. A devout Catholic, she'd insisted that Rose and Léa start catechism classes at the age of six. Maman, a seamstress, had sewn a white dress for Rose to wear the day of her First Holy Communion. Overwhelmed by the sweet, heady scent of white lilies and the light streaming in through stained-glass windows, splashing color on the stone columns, Rose had to be nudged by the girl beside her to move forward when it was her turn to take the Eucharist. Though her mother struggled to earn enough money, Rose carried fond memories of her childhood. She'd been happy then. Life was simpler than now. Entering the cathedral, she wanted to light a candle in remembrance of her mother and all she'd done for her.

When she came back out, the bells rang three times, but André was